FINANCIAL ALLIANCE FOR WOMEN

MEASURING THE VALUE OF THE FEMALE ECONOMY

ALLIANCE ANALYTICS

2025 EDITION

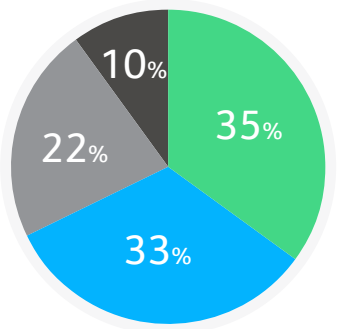
FINANCIAL ALLIANCE FOR WOMEN

This is the ninth edition of Measuring the Value of the Female Economy—the world's only comprehensive report tracking gender-disaggregated financial data from institutions serving Women's Markets.

This analysis draws on 2024 performance data from **53 financial institutions** across **34 countries** representing **63 percent of Alliance membership**. The dataset includes gender-disaggregated portfolio data and internal diversity metrics.

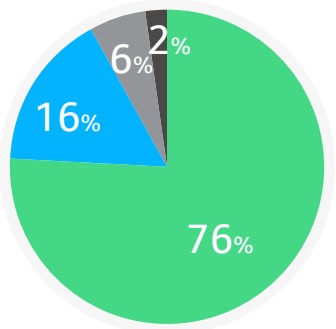
A note on historical comparisons: The set of respondents differs year-to-year due to changes in the membership base and reporting patterns. Therefore, historical comparisons are not based on a totally consistent dataset. Where trend analysis is done, it is based on similar samples.

Breakdown of Reporting Members by Region



Americas · Sub-Saharan Africa · Europe & the Middle East · Asia & Oceania

Breakdown of Reporting Members by Type of Institution



Commercial Bank · Fintech · Microfinance Institution · Insurance Company

MEASURING THE VALUE OF THE FEMALE ECONOMY

ALLIANCE ANALYTICS

2025 EDITION

This survey includes data that is self-reported by Alliance members, and although it has been reviewed, it has not been fully verified. Data granularity varies between financial service providers, and in some analyses, outliers have been excluded. Therefore, some of the results may include smaller sample sizes and represent still-emerging trends that we'll continue to analyze through the annual compilation of this data. All currency referenced is in US dollars.

MEASURING THE VALUE OF THE FEMALE ECONOMY

ALLIANCE ANALYTICS

2025 EDITION

Table of Contents

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY 4

- Executive Summary
- Alliance Impact

ALLIANCE MEMBERS' WOMEN-CENTERED STRATEGIES 6

- Programs and strategies
- Non-financial services

WOMEN'S MARKETS PERFORMANCE DATA 9

- Customers
- Credit & Savings
- Cards & Insurance
- Digital Financial Services

BUSINESS CASE DATA 17

- Risk
- Loyalty

DIVERSITY AND INCLUSION DATA 19

- Women-in-leadership trends

GLOSSARY 22

- Glossary of terms

Highlights

Women's representation as customers is growing across segments.
Women's representation has grown in all four main customer segments (Retail Banking/Consumer, High-Net-Worth Individual, Microenterprise, and SME) for the past three years.

With particular fast growth in the High-Net-Worth Individuals (HNWI) segment.
Women's representation in the HNWI segment was 40 percent in 2024, up from 32 percent in 2022.

Women-led Small-to-Medium-Sized Enterprises (WSMEs) are accessing larger loans than ever before.
Their average loan size grew to 88 percent of male-led SMEs in 2024, up from 76 percent in 2022.

The business case for serving Women's Markets remains strong.
Women continue to demonstrate lower default rates, similar product adoption, and higher Net Promoter Scores compared to men.

These market gains are matched by progress in gender diversity within organizations.
Women now represent 44 percent of senior managers—up from 33 percent just five years ago.

These results demonstrate the opportunity for more financial institutions to target Women's Markets. We encourage all financial service providers to adopt the holistic, gender-intelligent approach modeled by Alliance members and unlock the full potential of the Female Economy.

Key statistics:

45%
of total customers are women, vs. 39% in 2020

88%
women-led SMEs average loan size as % of men-led, vs. 67% in 2020

60
women's average Net Promoter Score, vs. 54 for men

44%
of senior managers are women, vs. 33% in 2020

Alliance members' collective impact

64M women customers served

$258B credit outstanding to women

$140B savings held by women

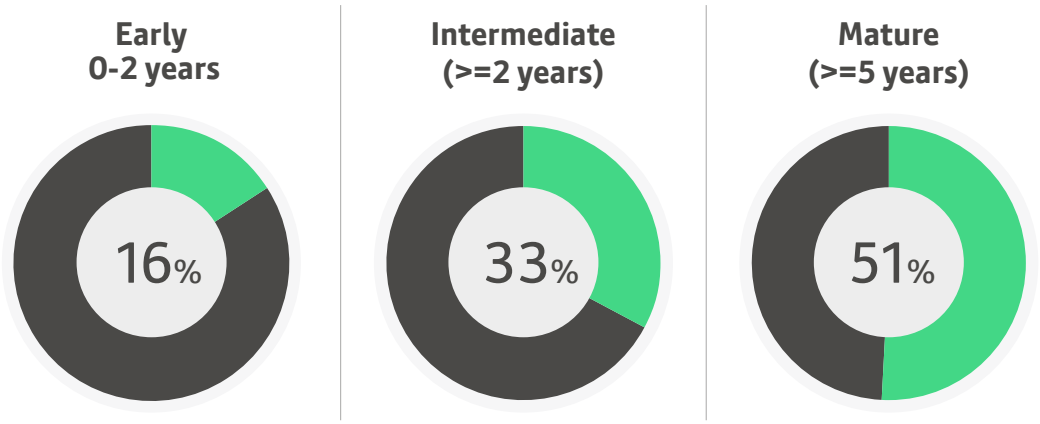
8.4M women accessed non-financial services

5.5M women MSMEs served

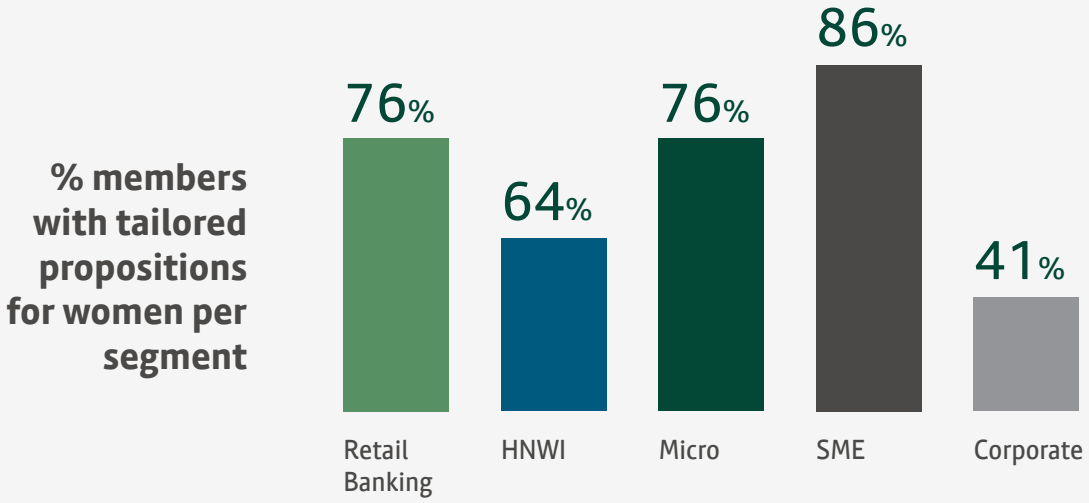
PROGRAMS & STRATEGIES

As a growing network, the Alliance has members with Women's Markets Programs ranging from early-stage (0-2 years) to mature (>= 5 years). The average tenure of programs is 7.4 years.

% members by Women's Markets Program maturity



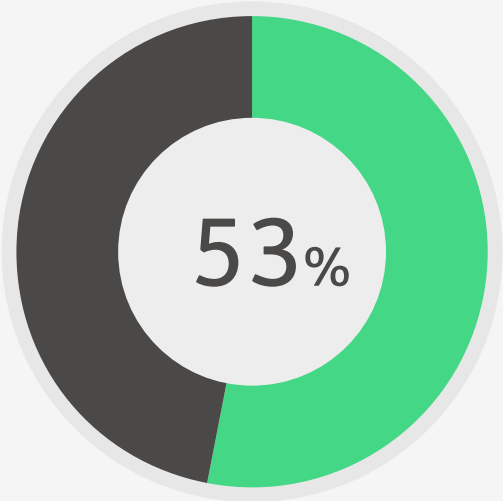
Members offer tailored propositions for women in various segments.



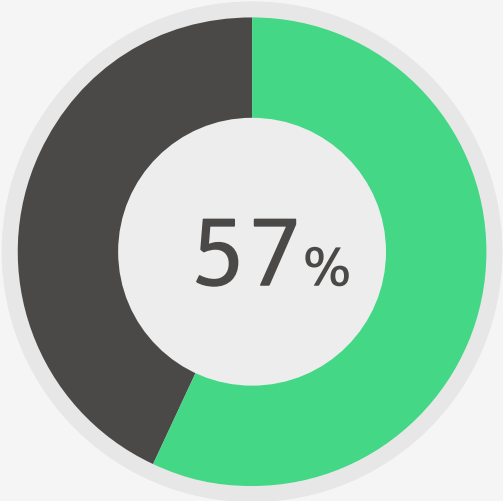
PROGRAMS & STRATEGIES

More than half of members target previously un-banked women and women with informal businesses.

% members targeting previously unbanked women



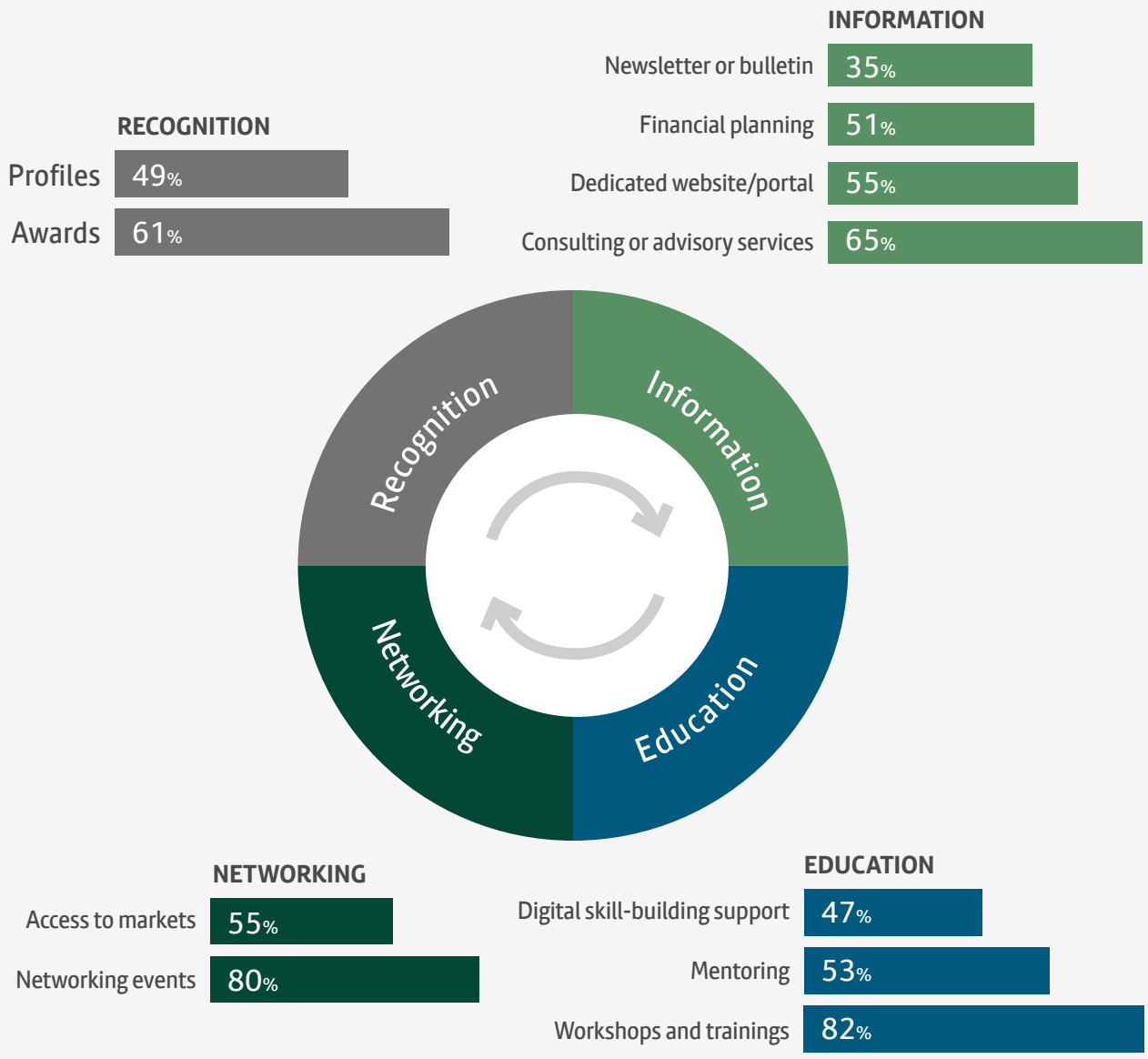
% members targeting women business owners in the informal economy



NON-FINANCIAL SERVICES

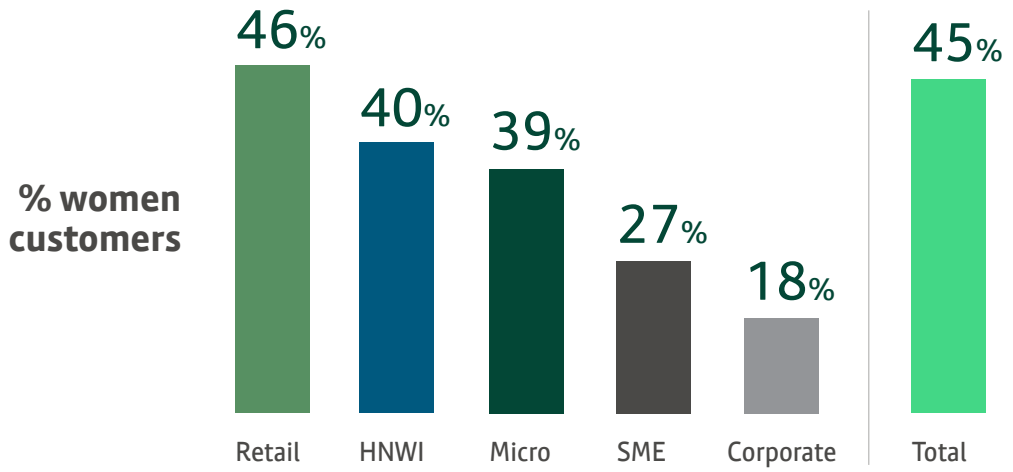
84 percent of Alliance members offer non-financial services (NFS) specifically designed for women.

% members providing NFS for women customers, by service type

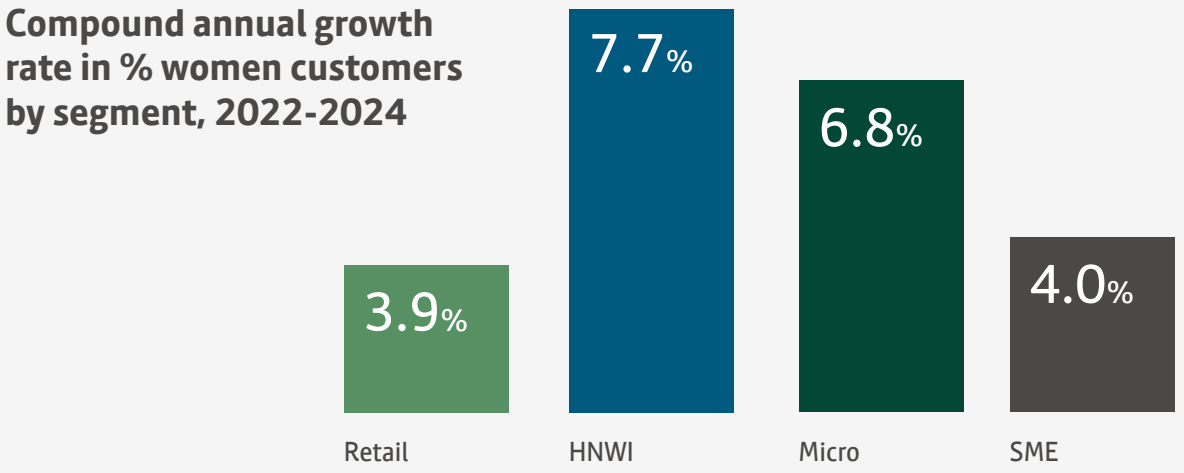


CUSTOMERS

As a result of members' holistic value propositions, women now make up 45 percent of total customers.

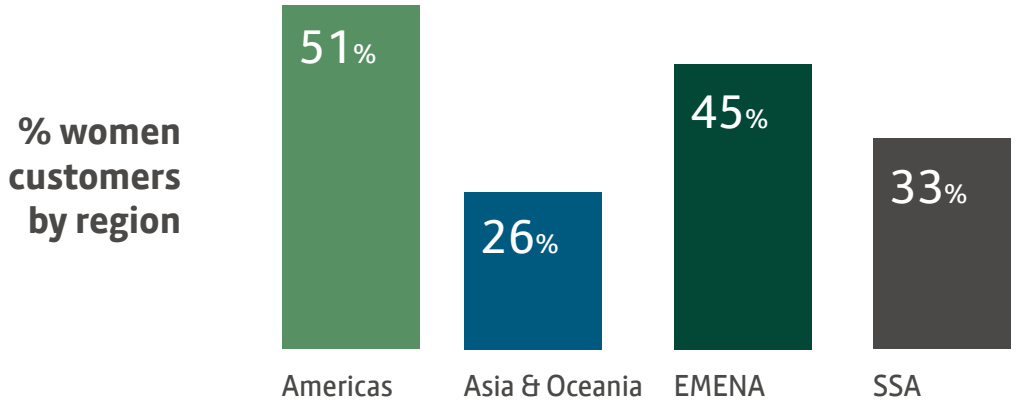


Women's representation increased across all core segments in the last 3 years.

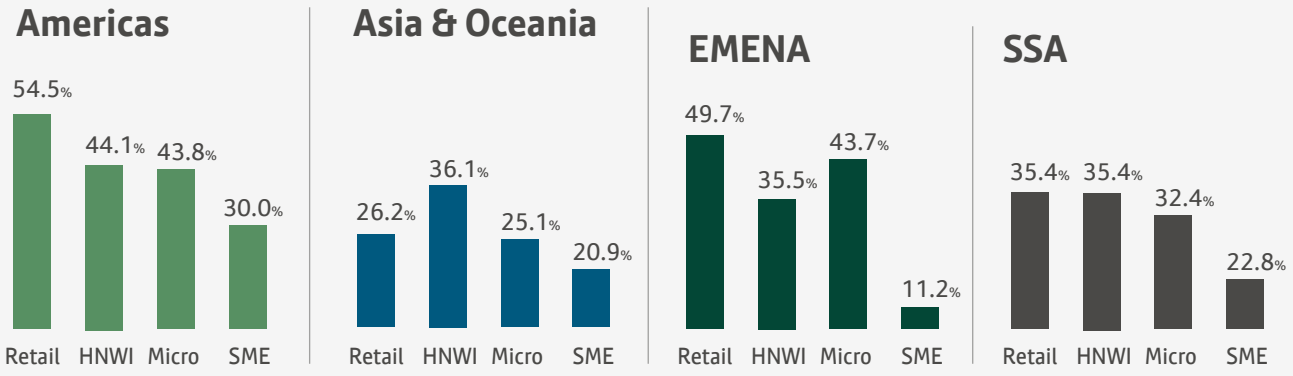


CUSTOMERS

Members in the Americas have the highest share of total customers that are women, followed by Europe and the Middle East.



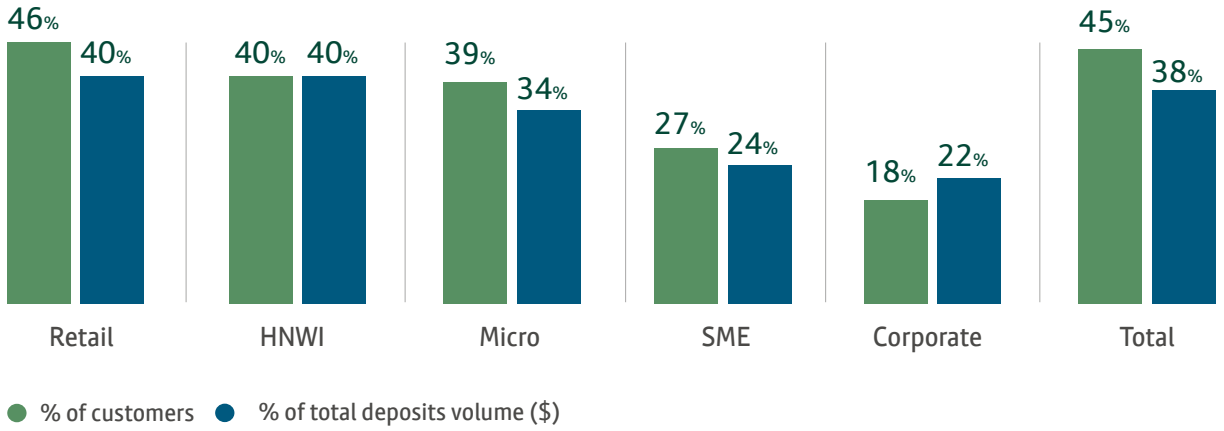
As expected, the retail segment has the highest representation of women in all regions with the exception of Asia & Oceania, where the HNWI takes the lead. Women's representation in the SME segment is at 30 percent for the Americas, mirroring the market, while other regions have considerable room to grow.



CREDIT & SAVINGS

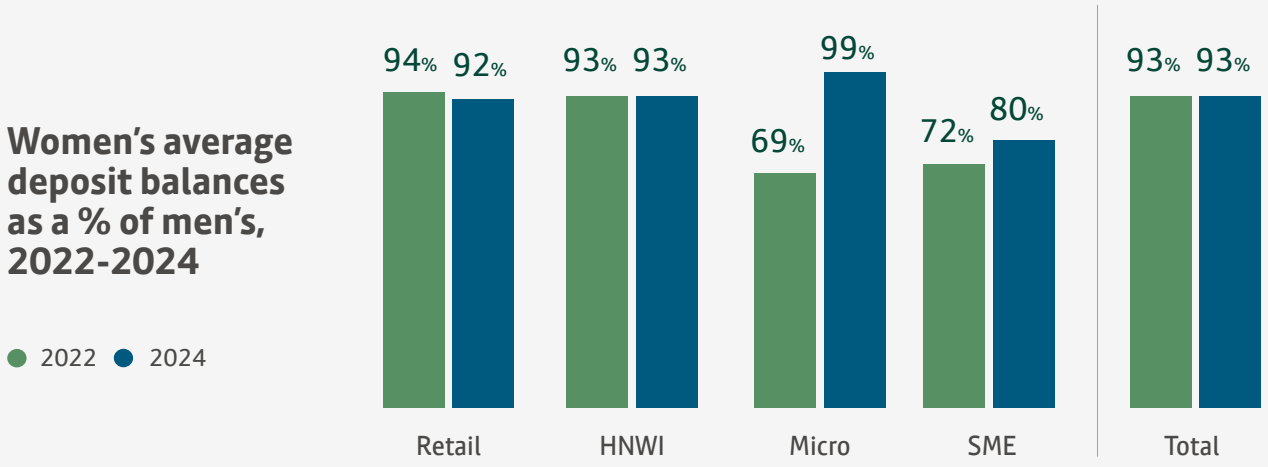
Women's share of total deposit volume remains lower than their share of customers for all segments except High-Net-Worth Individuals and Corporates.

% women customers vs. % of total deposits



Women's average deposit balances have held steady at 93 percent of men's, with notable increases in the Micro and SME segments.

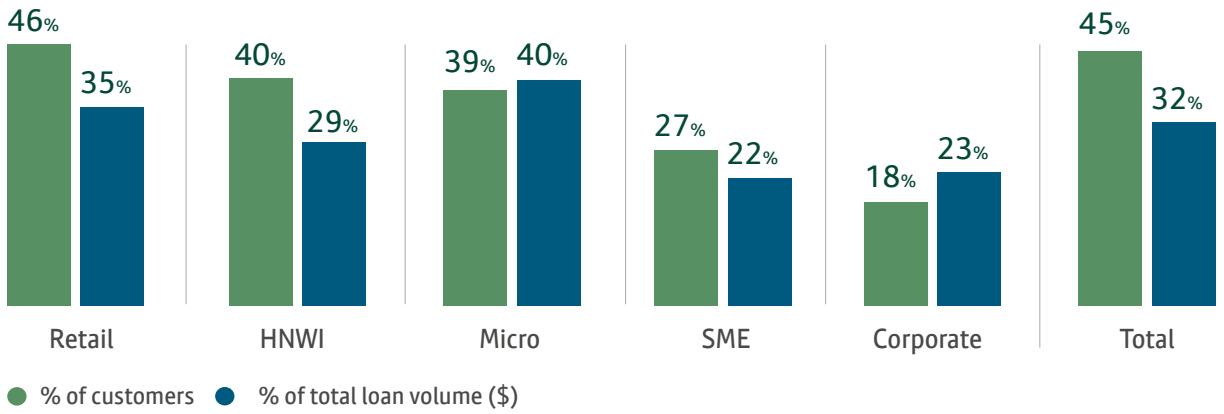
Women's average deposit balances as a % of men's, 2022-2024



CREDIT & SAVINGS

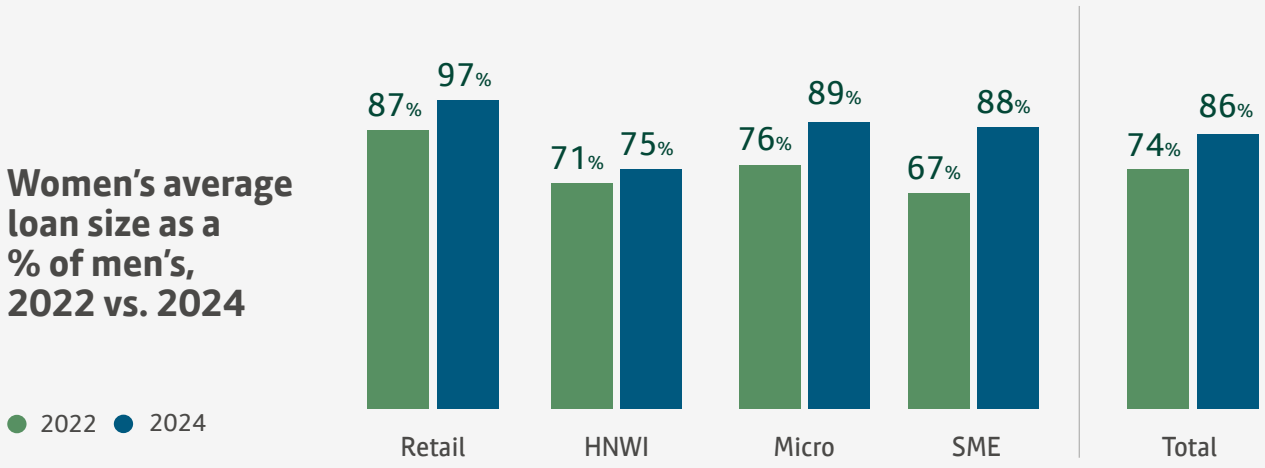
Women's share of loan volume remains lower than their share of customers for all segments except Microenterprises and Corporates.

% women customers vs. % of total loan volume



But their average loan size is growing relative to men's in all segments.

Women's average loan size as a % of men's, 2022 vs. 2024

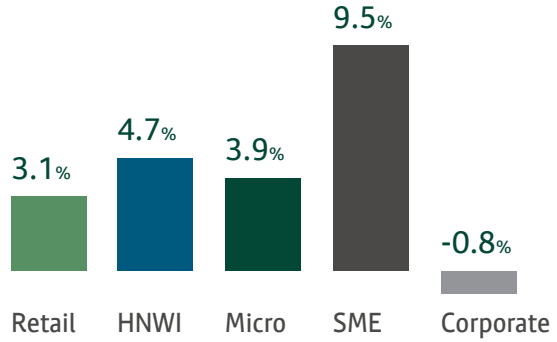


Corporate segment excluded due to low sample size.

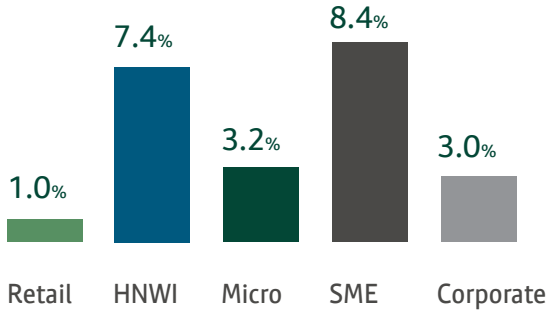
CREDIT & SAVINGS

Women SMEs' share of total savings and credit volume have grown rapidly in the past five years.

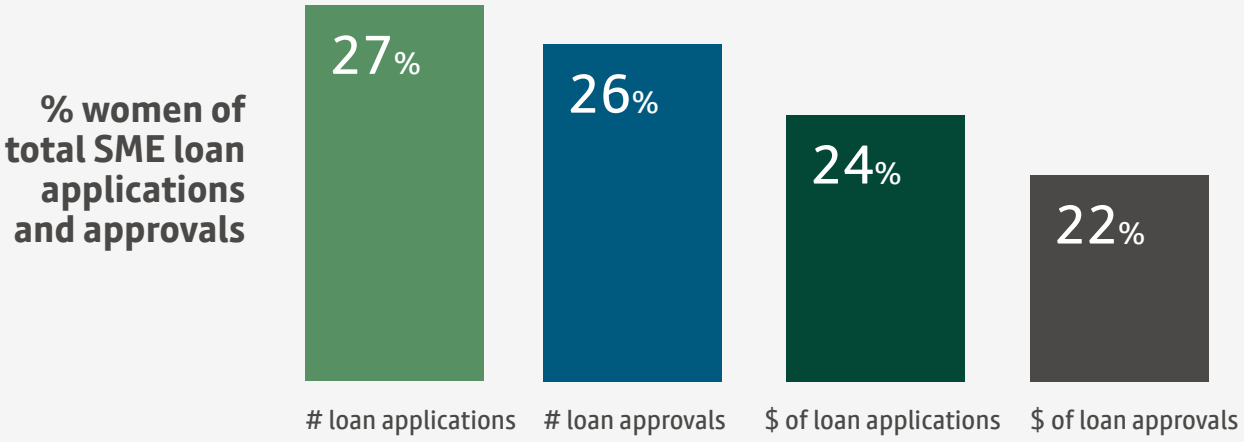
Compound annual growth rate in women's % of total loan volume, 2020-2024



Compound annual growth rate in women's % of total deposit volume, 2020-2024



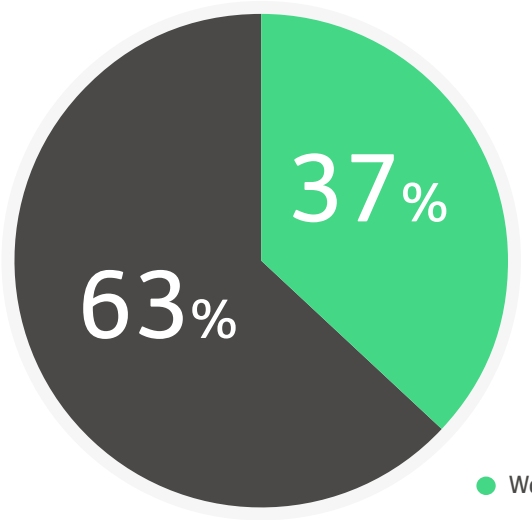
Women SMEs accounted for 27 percent of SME loan applications and 26 percent of loan approvals—demonstrating equitable access. However women account for just 24 percent of loan applications by volume.



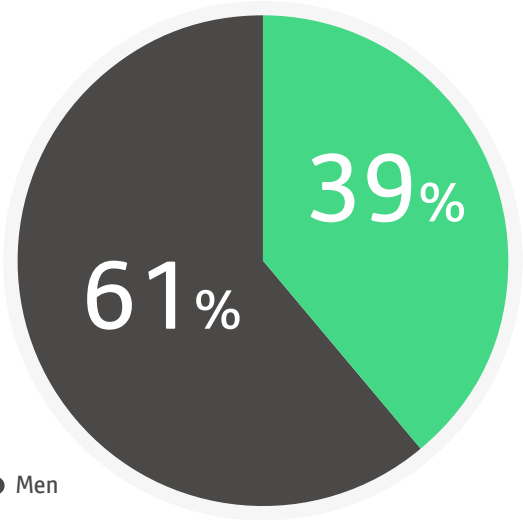
CARDS

Credit and debit card ownership has not reached parity.

% women credit card customers



% women debit card customers

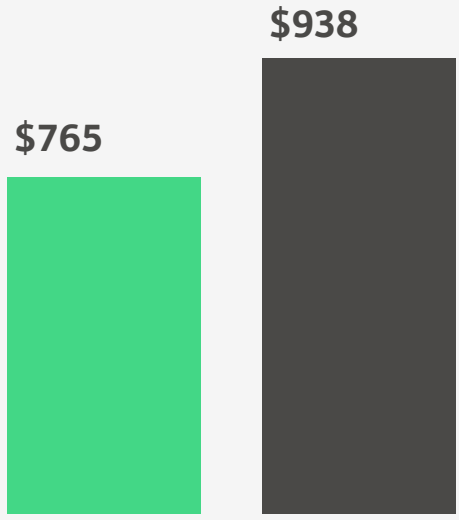


Women Men

Women continue to have lower average credit card balances than men.

Women Men

Average credit card balance

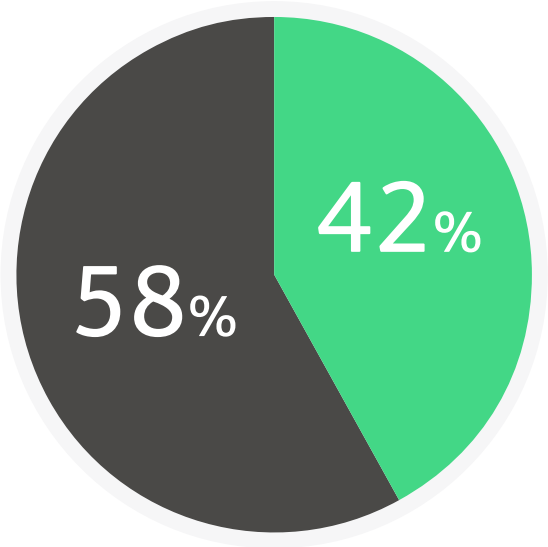


INSURANCE

Women make up 42 percent of insurance customers.

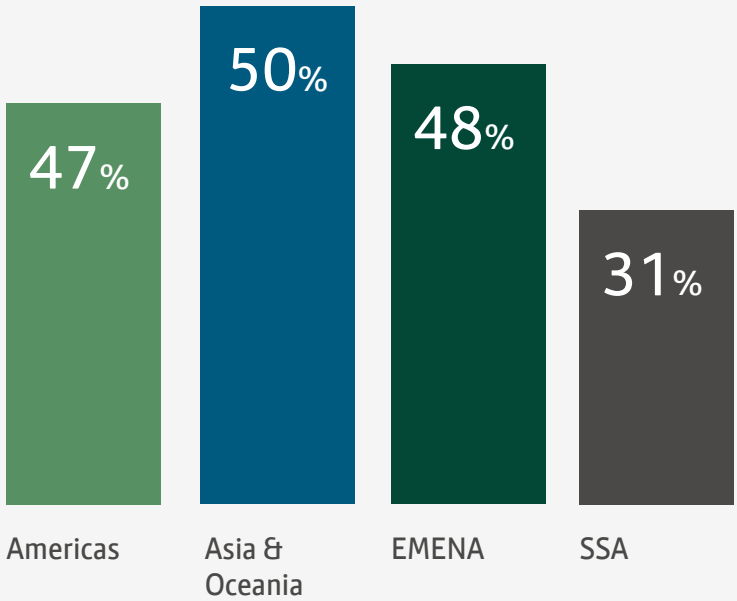
Women Men

% women insurance customers



And have reached 50 percent of insurance customers in Asia & Oceania.

% women insurance customers by region

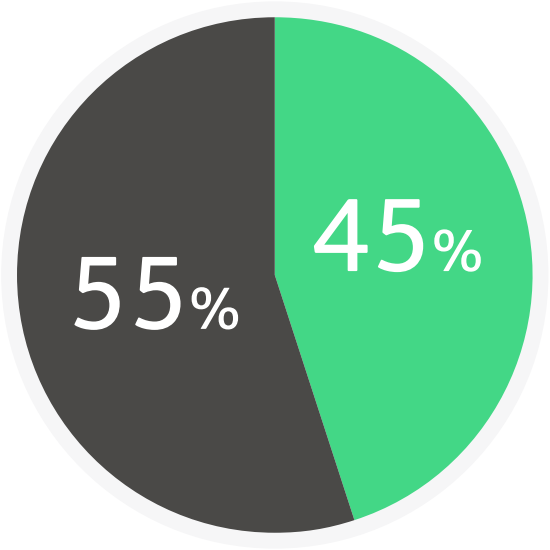


DIGITAL FINANCIAL SERVICES (DFS)

Women value convenience, making up 45 percent of banking app users.

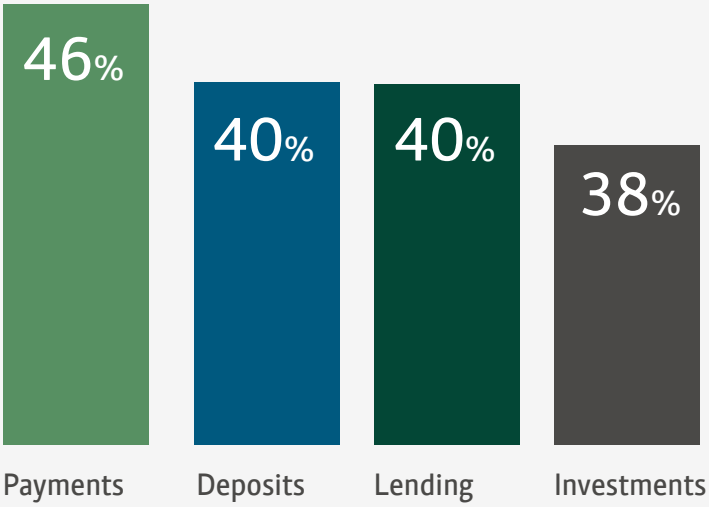
Women Men

% women of total banking app users



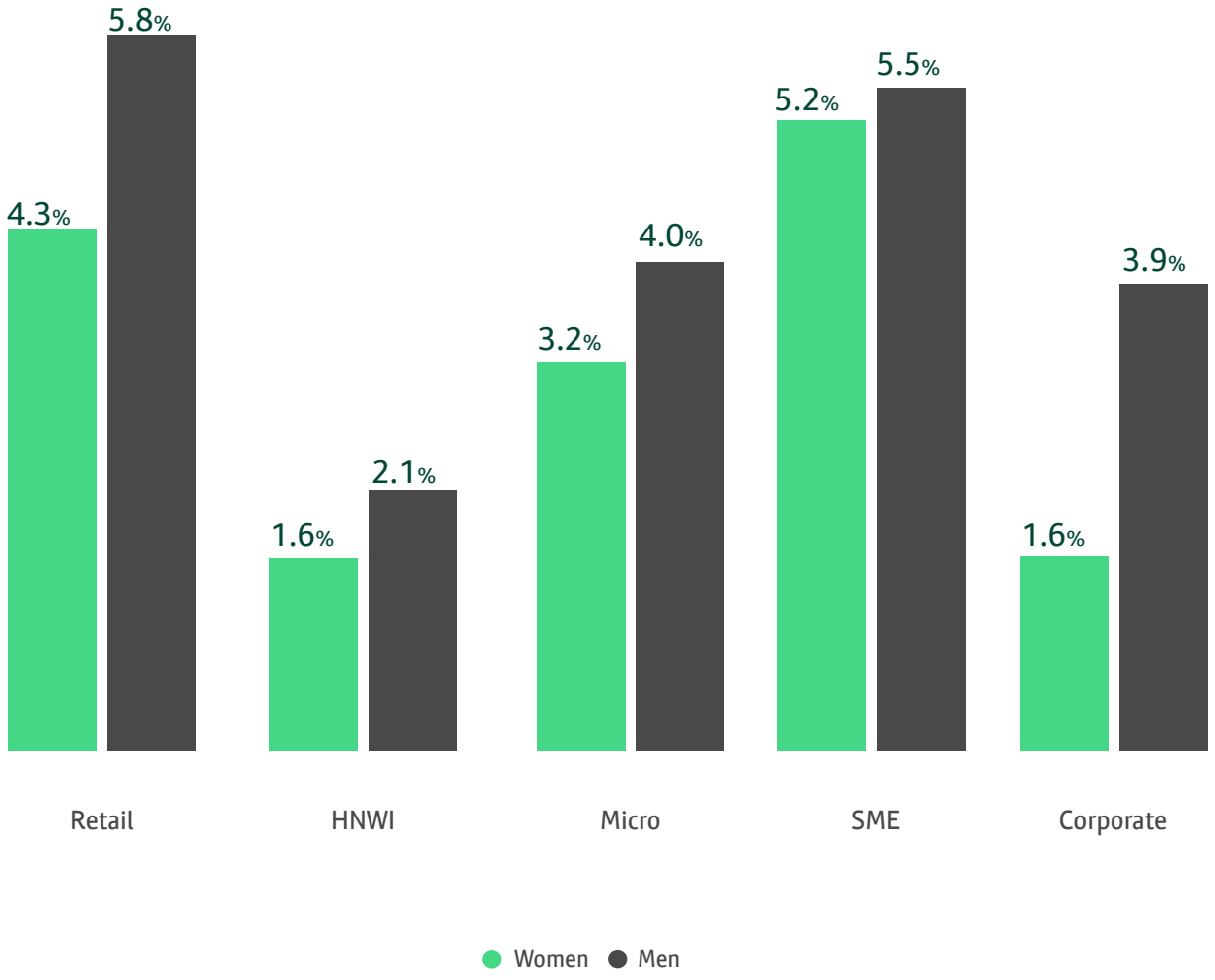
Payments are the most popular use of DFS by women, followed by Savings, Loans and Investments.

% women of users by DFS type



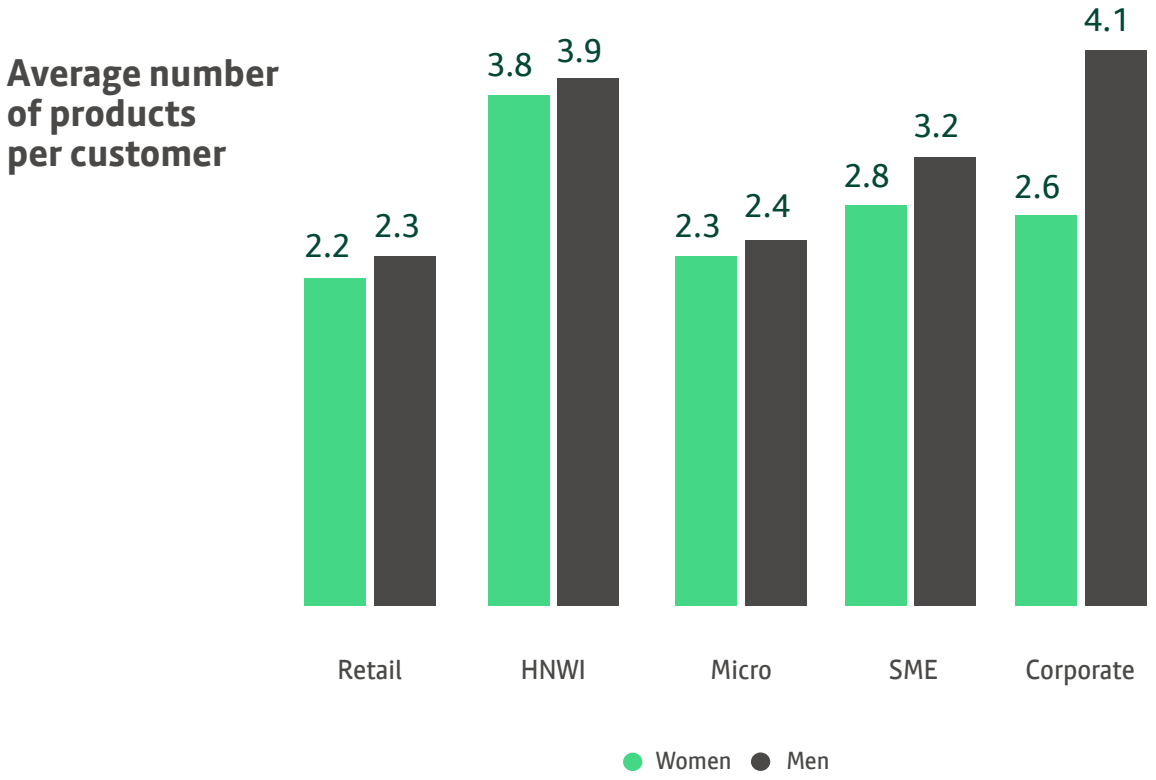
RISK

As in all prior years, women paid back their loans at greater rates than men across segments.

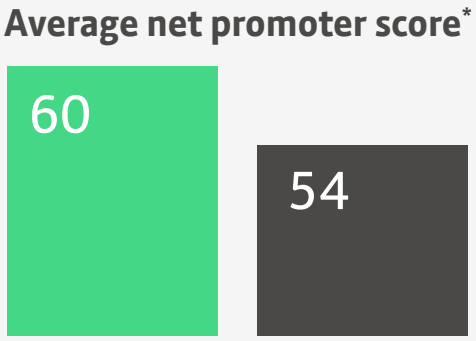


LOYALTY

Women are approaching parity with men in number of products per customer for all segments except Corporate.



And further demonstrate loyalty by being more likely to recommend the financial services provider to others.

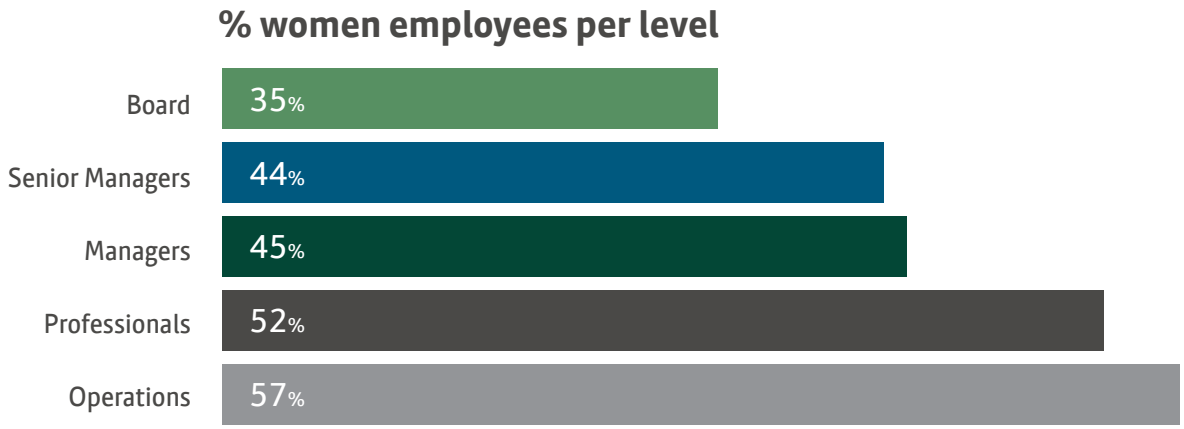


*Scores are based on a 100-point scale.

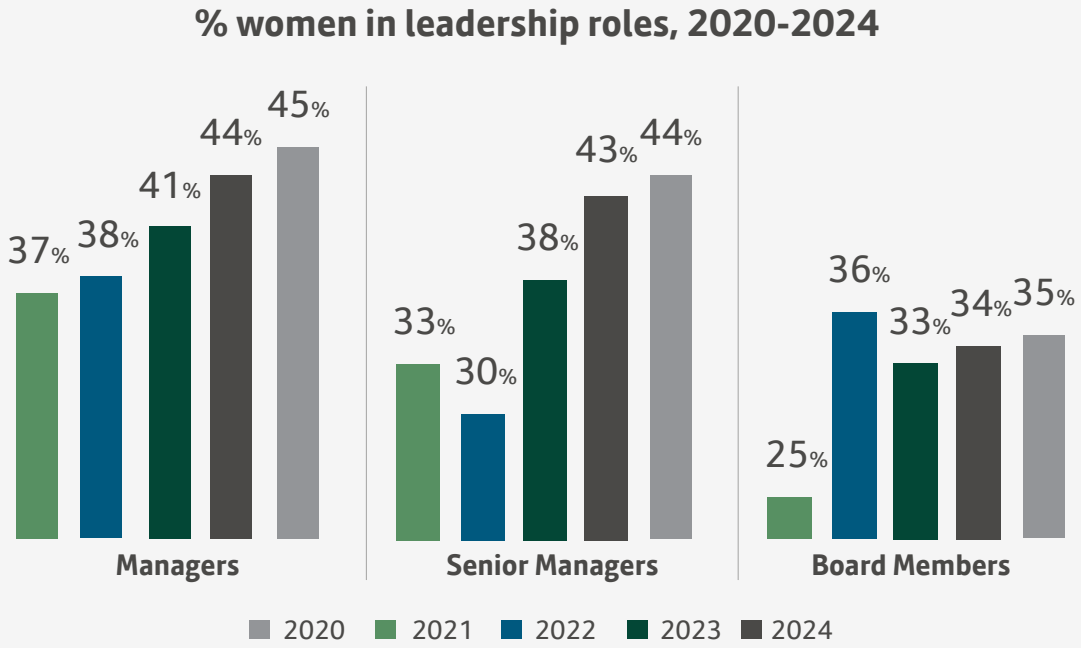
Women Men

WOMEN IN LEADERSHIP DATA

While women continue to be underrepresented at the top of organizations, the gap is closing.



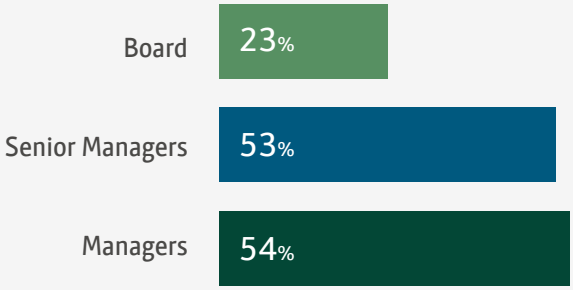
Women made up 45 percent of managers and 44 percent of senior managers across member organizations in 2024–significant improvements from just 5 years ago.



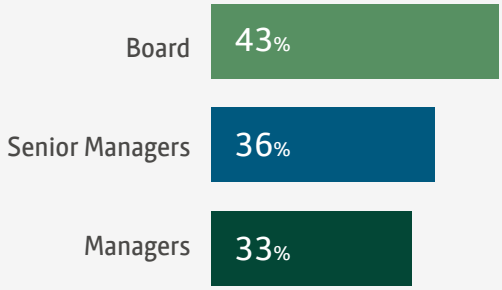
REGIONAL BREAKDOWN

Members in EMENA have the highest representation of women on boards, while the Americas has the highest representation in middle and senior management.

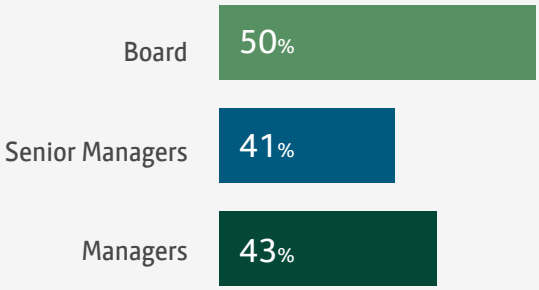
% women in leadership, Americas



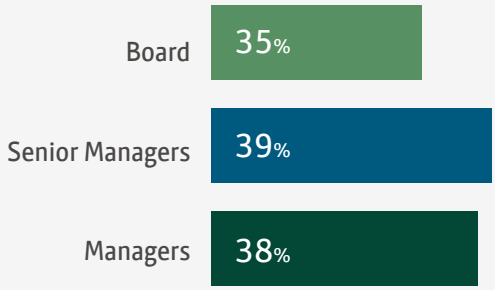
% women in leadership, Asia & Oceania



% women in leadership, EMENA



% women in leadership, SSA



CONCLUSION

Let's build on this momentum to tap into the full power of the Female Economy.

This comprehensive dataset provides comprehensive insight into how financial services providers are serving women's markets—but many still struggle to consistently collect and analyze quality sex-disaggregated data.

To address this, the Alliance offers robust support through initiatives like our acclaimed Gender Data Learning Series, an in-depth course equipping providers with skills to develop women-centered strategies using sex-disaggregated data. Best practices and case studies are codified in our growing resource library, including *Collecting and Using Banking Data on Women Businesses: A How-To Guide for Financial Institutions* and *The Power of Women's Markets Data: A How-To Guide*.

We also champion gender data globally through the Women's Financial Inclusion Data (WFID) partnership, which supports national regulators in leveraging data to advance women's financial inclusion, and the WE Finance Code, a cross-sector commitment to close the financing gap for women entrepreneurs that launched in 30 countries in 2024–2025.

Yet data is merely the foundation—action is the goal. We remain committed to collaborating with members and ecosystem partners to transform these insights into solutions that unlock the full potential of the Female Economy.

GLOSSARY OF TERMS

Segments

Retail
The retail segment—also known as consumer or personal banking—includes products such as personal loans, savings accounts and payment services for the general public. The retail segment excludes high-net-worth individuals.

HNWI
High Net Worth Individuals (HNWI) refers to a customer segment of individuals and joint accounts with investable assets over a specific amount. FSPs typically provide exclusive services such as wealth management, estate planning, tax services, etc.

Micro
Micro enterprises are very small businesses, often sole-proprietorships, defined as those with fewer than ten employees. However, the definition varies by market and institution.

SME
SMEs are small and medium enterprises or businesses, usually defined as employing 11-250 employees, or turning over a certain amount of revenue. The definition varies by market and institution.

Corporate
Corporates are large companies generally employing more than 250 people or turning over a certain amount of revenue. The definition varies by market and institution.

WSME
The Alliance recommends that members use the IFC definition for WSME: An enterprise qualifies as a woman-owned enterprise if it meets the following criteria: (A) ≥ 51% owned by woman/women; OR (B) ≥ 20% owned by woman/women; AND (i) has ≥ 1 woman as CEO/COO/President/Vice President; AND (ii) has ≥ 30% of the board of directors composed of women, where a board exists.

Digital Financial Services

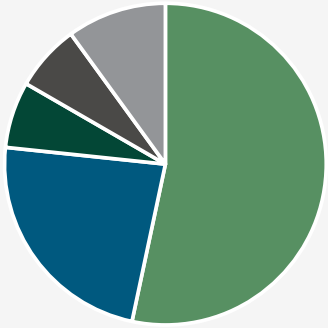
Online banking
Online banking allows a user to conduct financial transactions via the internet. Online banking is also known as Internet banking or web banking.

Dedicated Mobile App
Also known as a mobile application or app, a dedicated mobile app is a program designed to run on a mobile device such as a phone or tablet. It must be downloaded onto a device.

Online Payments and Transfers
The transfer of funds between parties digitally without exchange of cash.

Online Lending
Borrowing products that can be accessed only through digital platforms and allow the underwriting process to be initiated, effected and funds to be transferred to the borrower directly online without any physical interaction between the FSP and customer.

% members using each definition for women-owned businesses:



The Financial Alliance for Women would like to thank all of its members who participated in this survey for their time, commitment and willingness to share their data.

FINANCIAL ALLIANCE FOR WOMEN

About the Financial Alliance for Women

We're the leading members' network of financial organizations dedicated to championing the Female Economy — the world's largest, fastest-growing market, and yet one that remains untapped. As a unique network with members from over 160 countries, we share the ambition of unlocking the full value of the Female Economy.

Everything we do is based on a win-win approach where financial organizations grow their businesses by accelerating women's financial power.

From creating unparalleled learning opportunities where members can share best practices from on-the-ground experiences, to publishing our own proprietary data and research, to advocating for global policy change — we inspire and equip our members to design and refine women-centered products, services and strategies that will bring about a new paradigm for women's financial experiences.

MEASURING THE VALUE OF THE FEMALE ECONOMY

ALLIANCE ANALYTICS

2025 EDITION

FINANCIAL ALLIANCE FOR WOMEN

FinancialAllianceforWomen.org

Financial Alliance for Women

Financial Alliance for Women © 2026